

SHOMRITA BARUA, BDS, MPH(c)

Public Health | Health Policy & Equity | Community-Based Research

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Bilingual public health professional with clinical training in dentistry and graduate expertise in epidemiology, health equity, and community-based research. Skilled in policy analysis, language access programming, and culturally responsive health communication for refugee, immigrant, and Limited English Proficient (LEP) populations. Combines state public health agency practicum experience (CT DPH), peer-reviewed research, and multilingual community engagement to translate evidence into equitable, systems-level public health solutions.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Health Policy Analysis • Public Health Law & Language Access (Title VI, EO 13166) • Health Equity & Social Determinants of Health • Community-Based Participatory Research (CBPR) • Refugee & Immigrant Health • Mental Health Service Utilization • Cultural Competence & Culturally Responsive Communication • Stakeholder & Interagency Engagement • Systematic Reviews & Evidence Synthesis • Mixed-Methods Research • Grant Writing & Program Evaluation • Health Communication & Visual Education Design • Multilingual Outreach (Bengali, English, Hindi, Urdu)

EDUCATION

Master of Public Health (MPH)

Expected May 2026

University of Connecticut, Department of Public Health Sciences — Storrs, CT

Capstone: Mental Health Service Utilization Among South Asian Immigrants in the United States — Examined cultural, structural, and policy-level barriers to mental health care including stigma, language access, and provider cultural competence; synthesized evidence into culturally responsive service delivery and policy recommendations.

Master of Public Health (MPH)

2018 – 2020

National Institute of Preventive and Social Medicine (NIPSOM), BSMMU — Bangladesh

Bachelor of Dental Surgery (BDS)

2011 – 2016

University of Chittagong — Bangladesh

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Student Intern — Language Access Workshop Project

Jun 2025 – Present

Department of Public Health Sciences, UConn Health, CT | Supervisor: Dr. Stacey Brown

- **Designed and facilitated** community workshops to advance language access for LEP and immigrant populations in Connecticut, applying federal civil rights and Title VI language access frameworks to programmatic decisions.
- **Conducted community-based participatory research** with interdisciplinary stakeholders (DPH staff, CBOs, language access providers) to inform expansion of multilingual health services and reduce inequities for LEP communities.
- **Contributed to grant writing, project management, and presentation deliverables**, translating public health policy and evidence into accessible, multilingual educational materials for diverse community audiences.

Student Intern — Refugee & Immigrant Health Practicum

Sep 2024 – Dec 2024

Connecticut Department of Public Health (CT DPH), Hartford, CT

- **Completed** a state-agency practicum focused on refugee and immigrant health, conducting comparative cross-jurisdictional analysis of state DPH refugee health programs to identify policy gaps and best practices.
- **Designed** semi-structured interview guides and synthesized findings from key stakeholder interviews into policy recommendations on refugee health access, language access, and culturally responsive service delivery.
- **Contributed to** interagency policy discussions on immigrant health services, integrating health equity and rights-based frameworks into program assessment.
- **Performed** systematic data collection and cross-site analyses to inform CT DPH's refugee health program evaluation and public reporting.

Graduate Assistant — Research & Administration

2023 – Dec 2024

Department of Public Health Sciences, UConn Health, CT

- **Supported research** on long-acting injectable buprenorphine for opioid use disorder under Dr. Megan O. Grady, conducting evidence synthesis and literature reviews on substance use treatment access and disparities.

- **Designed key informant** interview instruments and stakeholder communication strategies for the CT DPH Workforce Pipeline Project, advancing public health workforce diversity and equity goals.
- **Managed** project documentation, monthly progress reports, and stipend administration for 15+ DPH-funded students and trainees across multiple equity-focused initiatives.
- **Supported** recruitment and outreach for departmental academic and equity programming, supporting a more inclusive public health pipeline.

Medical Officer — COVID-19 Pandemic Response

Apr 2020 – Jun 2022

Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS), Bangladesh

- **Delivered telehealth** services and triage for COVID-19 patients via the national Corona Lab Call Center, applying culturally and linguistically responsive communication for diverse populations.
- **Joined** the COVID-19 Emergency Response & Pandemic Preparedness team, supporting national surveillance, qualitative/quantitative data management, and evidence-driven decision-making for government health programs.
- **Contributed to development of** national health policy frameworks, project proposals, and program reports addressing pandemic mitigation, system resilience, and equitable service delivery.

Data Enumerator — Vector-Borne Disease Research

Feb 2020 – Mar 2020

National Institute of Preventive and Social Medicine (NIPSOM), Bangladesh

- **Collected** *Aedes aegypti* specimens and field data for the project “Climate Impacts on Rising Infection of Dengue and Chikungunya in Bangladesh — A Time Series Analysis.”
- **Analyzed** environmental and social drivers of vector-borne disease burden, contributing to climate-health systems thinking research.

SELECTED RESEARCH & SCHOLARLY PROJECTS

- **Visual Health Communication:** Designed original infographics and culturally tailored awareness resources on South Asian immigrant mental health (capstone-aligned) for community-level health communication.
- **Public Health Law Analysis:** Reviewed federal and state language access policies (Title VI of the Civil Rights Act, Executive Order 13166, CMS LEP guidance) and implementation gaps for LEP populations.
- **Conference Poster, 2024 CT Public Health Association Annual Conference:** “Caretakers’ Fruit and Vegetable Shopping Patterns: A Community-Based Pilot Study to Strengthen Farmers Market Benefits Among Overweight/Obese Children Ages 2–5 in the Hartford WIC Program.”
- **Systematic Review:** Food insecurity and mental health outcomes in pregnant women and mothers.
- **Community-Based Research:** Dietary habits and oral health status among tribal elderly populations in Bangladesh.
- **Policy Analysis Project:** Medicinal cannabis use, side effects, and legalization policy among cancer patients.
- **Outcome Evaluation:** Doctor-patient communication skills training for pre-intern physicians (Bangladesh Society of Medicine).

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Barua, S., et al. (2024). *Oral health vulnerability and its associated risk factors among tribal elderly people in Bangladesh: a primary pilot initiative of national oral health survey*. Global Biosecurity. <https://doi.org/10.31646/gbio.232>

Haque, M.F., Rahman, M.M., ... Barua, S., et al. (2021). *Estimation and prediction of doubling time for COVID-19 epidemic in Bangladesh: a study of first 14 months’ daily confirmed new cases and deaths*. Global Biosecurity, 3(1). <https://doi.org/10.31646/gbio.91>

Bosu, S., Haque, M.F., Barua, S., et al. (2021). *Job Satisfaction of Health Assistants in Selected Upazila Health Complexes in Bangladesh*. [In press]

TECHNICAL & METHODOLOGICAL SKILLS

Data & Analysis: SPSS, Microsoft Excel, Qualtrics, Rayyan (systematic review)

Research Methods: Quantitative & qualitative methods, key informant interviews, community-based participatory research (CBPR), systematic review & meta-analysis, evidence synthesis, literature appraisal, data abstraction

Health Communication & Design: Canva (infographics, visual education), Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, Outlook, scientific poster design, visual storytelling, grant and report writing, public presentation

Languages: Bengali (native), English (fluent), Hindi (conversational), Urdu (comprehension)

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY SERVICE

E-Board Member, Media Management — Public Health Student Organization (PHSO), UConn Health • **Volunteer** — Hands on Hartford (community health & food access); UConn Lifestyle Medicine Group; Adult Literacy Educator at Literacy Services of Indian River, FL (2023); organized donation drives & community outreach with unhoused and vulnerable populations in the U.S. and Bangladesh.